Onboarding Assistant

An AI answer desk for new hires, and a gap-finder for the company.

The problem

New hires have dozens of small questions in their first weeks: time off, payroll, tools, who to contact. The answers are scattered across wikis, email and chat, and many people hesitate to ask their manager for fear of looking uninformed. Managers keep repeating themselves, and HR never sees which questions keep coming up.

The solution

One chat assistant that answers **only from the company's own handbook**, shows which section each answer came from, suggests related questions, and says so plainly when the handbook doesn't cover something. Personal or sensitive matters are routed to a real person instead of answered by a bot.

How it works

1. Load the handbook
The company adds its handbook. The demo uses a fictional 17-section handbook for "Meridian Works."

2. New hire asks
The assistant answers with sources and follow-up questions, or flags a gap instead of guessing.

3. Admin sees the gaps
Question insights ranks what the handbook is missing, with one-click "Add to handbook."

Key features

- **Source-cited answers** that link back to the handbook section.
- **Follow-up suggestions** after each answer.
- **Question insights** dashboard: ranked handbook gaps for the People team.
- **Editable shared handbook** that every new hire sees.
- **Two-week checklist** that tracks each person's progress privately.

Built-in safeguards

- Answers are limited to handbook text. No invented policies.
- Harassment, mental health, legal and similar topics are **sent to HR contacts and an ethics hotline**, not answered.
- Sensitive questions are counted by category. The text is saved only if the employee chooses to share it.
- Insights show **no names**, and new hires cannot read each other's entries.

Customer and business model

Target: small and mid-size companies (roughly 50 to 1,000 employees) with a small People team and steady hiring, so no dedicated onboarding staff. Buyer: HR or People leader. Users: new hires and their managers.

Revenue (illustrative, not yet validated): per-employee monthly subscription with an annual minimum, paid setup to import the handbook, and a higher tier adding Slack, Teams and HR-system integrations.

Competition and our edge

- **Company wikis and intranets** offer search, but don't say what's missing or route sensitive topics.
- **HR onboarding modules** provide checklists, not answers to individual questions.
- **General AI chatbots** aren't tied to a company's own policies and can guess.

Our edge: grounded answers, gap analytics, and privacy-first handling of sensitive topics.

Where it stands

A working prototype is built and tested on the fictional handbook. Known limits:

- It runs inside one organization's Claude accounts, and each user's usage counts toward their own plan.
- Sensitive-topic detection combines keywords with AI judgment. It would need HR and legal review before real use.

Next steps

- Production backend with company-owned API access and logins.
- Import handbooks from PDF, Word and Notion.
- Deliver answers inside Slack or Teams.
- Pilot with one or two companies. Measure time to first answer, manager questions avoided, and share of gaps fixed.

Working prototype available for live demonstration.